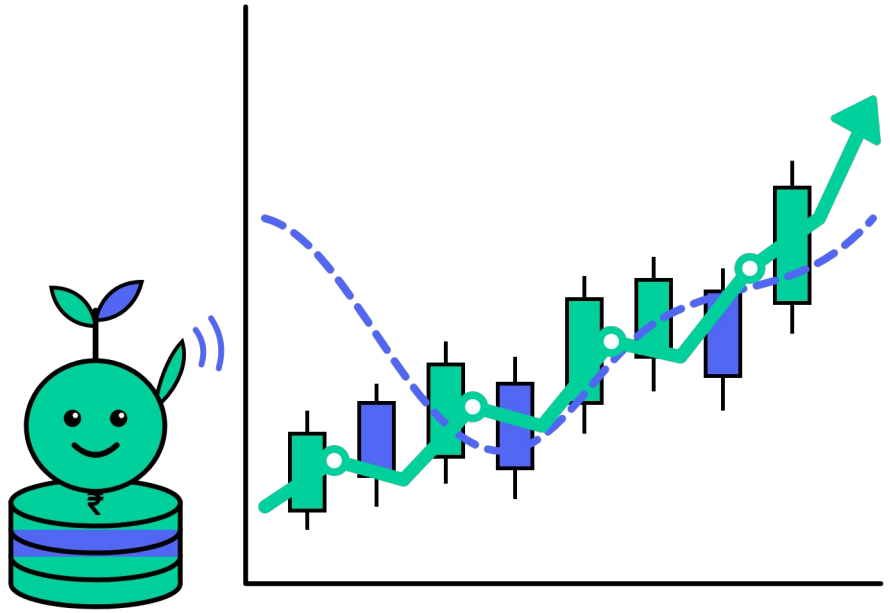
NextLeap graduation project | Growth PM case: Groww

Helping first-time Groww investors stay invested through year one



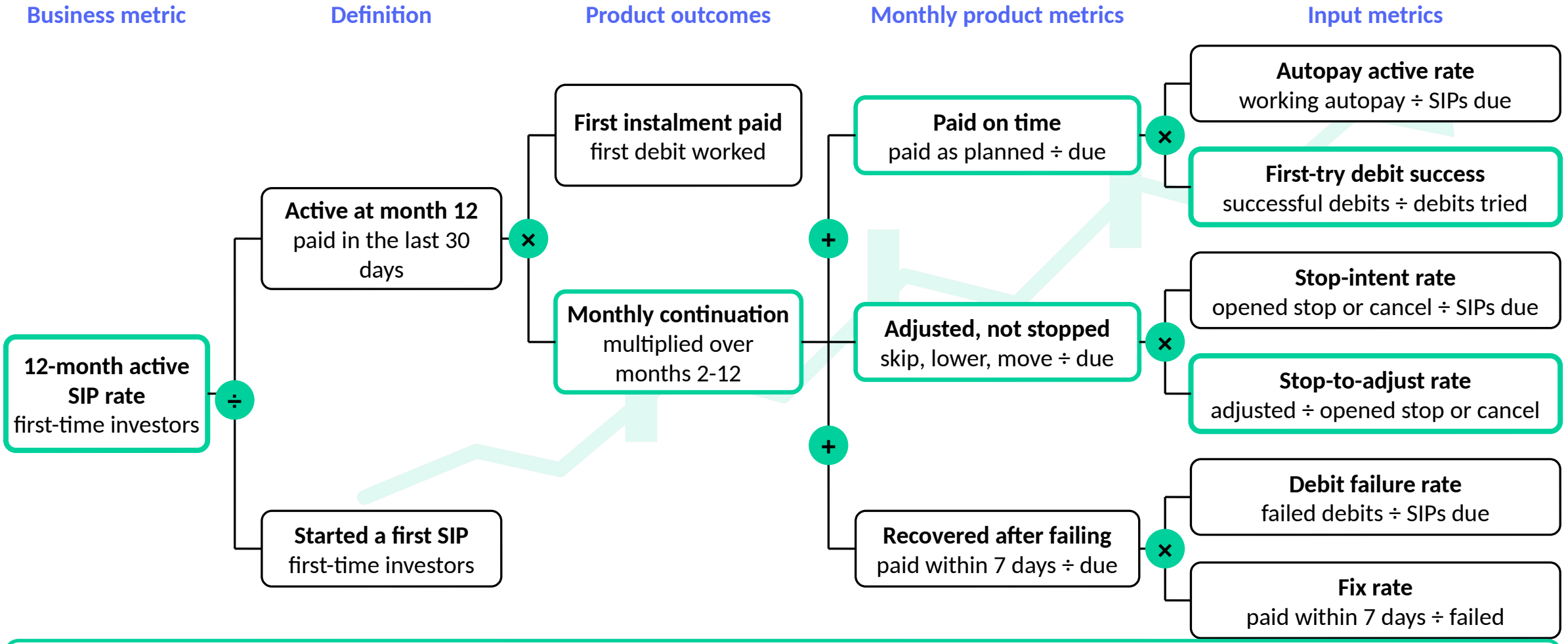
Why first-time investors stop their SIPs in year one, and SIPal: an in-app guide that explains each moment without giving advice

North-star metric: percentage of first-time mutual fund investors who still have an active SIP 12 months after starting their first one.

11,711 conversations analysed | **8,871** about real SIP journeys | **19**-person survey | **4** interviews | Discovery engine | SIPal MVP

Independent study. Not affiliated with Groww; Groww logo shown for identification only. Not investment advice. Mutual fund investments are subject to market risks.

KPI tree: the 12-month active SIP rate comes down to whether each monthly instalment is paid, adjusted or recovered



Steady SIP continuity can be increased by the first-try debit success rate and the stop-to-adjust rate.
The first keeps money flowing every month with no effort from the investor; the second turns a decision to leave into a smaller step.

Discovery and user research: 8,871 real SIP conversations show SIPs break at a missed payment or a low-returns month

How the AI discovery engine works

110K	public reviews, Reddit posts and comments, YouTube comments collected
21,073	kept after removing spam, ads and duplicates
11,711	read and labelled by Gemini: what happened, why, feeling, need
8,871	about a real person's own mutual fund SIP
334	show a SIP stopping, pausing or failing; 230 say why

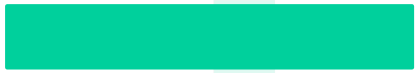
Checked: 97.8% of quotes word for word; a 20-post golden set labelled by hand.
Ask the live engine

Why SIPs stop: 230 stated reasons

Low returns, wrong expectations or confusing numbers



A missed or failed instalment (payment, autopay, app)



Money pressure or a life event (loan, job, move)



A better option elsewhere or others' advice



57% of stated reasons sit at two moments: a missed SIP and a low-returns month (solid bars).

What investors are telling us

1 A dip reads as a loss

"Sip band kar do kyun ki market aur gire ga."

2 A missed debit is a mystery

"Missed two SIP installments due to low balance will it affect my investment?"

3 Tight months need a middle path

"...whether to pause the SIP and focus on clearing the loan instead."

4 They want a trusted answer

It is the top need in 54% of first-year posts; answers come from YouTube and Reddit, not the app.

Chosen target segment: of about 2 to 3 million first-time Groww SIP investors a year, we choose salaried 22 to 30, the largest group

India's population ~1.4 billion

Mobile internet users ~958 million
68% of population | IAMAI 2025

Fintech app users 500M+ UPI users
~52% of internet users | NPCI-BCG 2025

Groww active users 16.7 million
~3% of UPI users | Groww Q4 FY26 letter

First-time SIP investors on Groww
~2 to 3 million a year (estimate)

Students, under 22	**Chosen segment** Salaried, 22-30	Variable income	Mid-career, 31+
29% of first-timers	**51% of first-timers**	12% of first-timers	8% of first-timers
~580K-870K a year	~1.0M-1.5M a year	~240K-360K a year	~160K-240K a year

The entry door
36% of new Groww users start with a SIP (Q2 FY26, up 7 points on last year). For many, the first SIP is their first product on Groww.

The leak
SIP stoppage ratio 78.5% in Sep 2026: 63.26 lakh new SIPs vs 49.68 lakh closed or completed. Acquisition works; keeping SIPs alive is the gap.

Estimate logic
~10M of 16.7M users hold mutual funds; 20-30% assumed to start a first SIP in a year. Segment shares: engine, first-year posts stating age or income.

Sources: IAMAI 2025 | NPCI-BCG | **Groww letter Q4 FY26** | Groww letter Q2 FY26 | SIP stoppage Sep 2026

Validated hypothesis: SIPs stop because first-timers get no proper guidance when they miss a SIP or returns are low

Target segment: salaried, 22-30, the largest group at 51% of first-time investors who state age or income

1 Starts with intent
Own goal or a friend's nudge; expects 10% to 15%+ a year

→

2 Trigger moment
Misses a SIP (forgot, layoff, a move) or sees low returns

→

3 Root cause: no proper guidance
No one explains what a miss leads to, or what to do at low returns

→

4 Doesn't know what to do
Asks a friend, advisors, Reddit, or does nothing

→

5 The SIP breaks
Missed, stopped, or cancelled and redeemed

With no guidance at a missed SIP or a low-returns moment, investors don't know what to do, and the SIP stops.

What 4 interviews showed

- Missed SIP: none of the 4 knew what several misses lead to
- Low returns: 2 of 4 thought of quitting, unsure what else to do
- With no guide, they asked a friend, advisors or Reddit, or did nothing
- Asked for it: “a proper guide to first time SIP investors”; found GR-1 only later
- 4 of 4 named a gentler path: move the date, pay less, skip a month

How we got here, and where it points

Started with: a doubt goes unanswered in the app.

Sharpened to: the gap is guidance at two moments, a missed SIP and low returns. Consistent with all 4 interviews.

Points to: an in-app guide at those two moments: what a miss leads to, the gentler options, and why returns move in year one. It explains; it never recommends funds.

Why Groww can fix it: the app already knows each debit date and sees every return, so it can step in at the right moment.

Survey and interviews: 10 of 19 thought of stopping, 9 did nothing next, and none of 4 interviewees knew what a missed SIP leads to

Survey snapshot (n=19)

10 of 19
thought of stopping or pausing (6 yes, 4 maybe)

9 of 19
did nothing next; 4 asked a friend, 3 followed influencers

5 and 5
said they needed money, or saw news of the market falling

3 and 3
missed an instalment, or paused or cancelled a SIP

Interview findings (4 salaried SIP investors)

- 0 of 4 knew what several missed instalments lead to
- 4 of 4 named a gentler path: move the date, pay less, skip a month
- 2 of 4 thought of quitting over low returns or jargon
- 3 of 4 started because a friend or sibling did
- All 4 want help as a notification, in plain words

A Akshata, 26 · Missed it, never meant to stop

Demographics: salaried, salary on the 1st; first-ever SIP in 2025, Rs 1,000 a month

App usage: opens Groww only when the SIP is due; paid by hand, then autopay

Key goals: long-term returns of 15%+; keep the SIP going without remembering it

Core friction: forgot to pay, missed 2 to 3 instalments; reminder lost in other alerts

P Praveen, 34 · Laid off, nearly quit

Demographics: salaried; first-ever SIP about 4 months ago, mid-month date

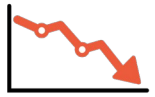
App usage: checks the graph every morning; has used skip and lowered the amount

Key goals: make money, at least 10% a year; understand the portfolio

Core friction: laid off and needed money; low returns made quitting tempting

Problem: when first-timers miss a SIP or see low returns, nothing guides them on what to do, so the SIP stops

1 What is the true problem?



Year one has two make-or-break moments: a missed instalment (forgot, laid off, moved) and a low-returns month. At both, first-timers don't know what a miss leads to, whether the returns are normal, or that they can skip, lower or move the SIP. Nothing in the app guides them then, so they ask friends or Reddit, freeze, or cancel.

2 Who faces it?

Salaried first-time investors, 22 to 30, in their first 12 months. 51% of first-timers who state age or income; about 1.0 to 1.5 million a year on Groww (estimate). Personas: Akshata and Praveen. Most started on a friend's or sibling's advice and rarely look for help on their own.

3 How do we know it is real?

- Hypothesis validated in 4 interviews: 0 of 4 knew what several misses lead to; 4 of 4 named a gentler path
- 57% of stated drop-off reasons sit at these two moments: missed SIPs 24%, low returns or confusing numbers 33% (n=230)
- A trusted answer is the top need in 54% of first-year posts

4 What value does solving it create?

For investors: at a missed SIP or a low-returns month, a clear answer to “what happens now, is this normal, what can I do”, and a gentler option than cancel.
For Groww: a higher 12-month active-SIP rate. Each +1 point keeps roughly 20,000 to 30,000 first-time investors a year (estimate), with fewer support contacts.
Why AI: each moment is personal (own numbers, own month), so one fixed FAQ cannot answer it; a checked AI can, for millions.

5 Why solve it now?

- Acquisition works, retention lags: record Rs 32,490 crore monthly SIPs, yet a 78.5% stoppage ratio (Sep 2026)
- 36% of new Groww users start SIP-first, so more first-timers reach these moments
- The pieces exist (skip, lower amount, GR-1) but don't appear at the moment: Akshata found GR-1 only later

Solution rationale: of three ideas, moment-based alerts score highest on RICE and fix the root cause, so SIPal builds on them

Idea	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE	Fixes the root cause at the moment?
1 Alerts with a calm guide: what happened, is it normal, what you can do	90%	2	80%	3	48	Yes: reaches investors at the missed-SIP and low-returns moments
2 AI voice bot in the Dashboards tab	10%	1	30%	4	0.8	No: the investor has to go and ask
3 SIPal guidebook with AI videos in Explore	20%	0.5	50%	5	1.0	Partly: general learning, not their moment

RICE = Reach x Impact x Confidence / Effort. Reach: share of the target segment touched in a quarter. Impact: 0.5 low to 3 massive. Effort: person-months. All values are estimates.

Why idea 1 wins

It is the only idea that comes to the investor at the moment. All 4 interviewees asked for a notification, and 57% of stated drop-off reasons sit at these two moments. It builds on what Groww already has: push notifications, each debit date and the portfolio. It also scores far higher on RICE: 48, against 1.0 and 0.8.

How it was refined

Weekly and 3 days before a debit, not daily: frequent return checks raise worry, and too many alerts get ignored. It explains with the investor's own funds and the week's economic reasons, offers gentler options (pay less, skip, move the date) and never gives advice. Every answer passes a quality check before it shows.

What it borrows

The name SIPal and the Explore entry come from idea 3, so the guide is also there whenever someone looks for it. A “Listen” button from idea 2 can come later for investors who prefer voice. The AI videos are dropped for now: they are costly to make, hard to check for accuracy, and general lessons are already free on YouTube.

MVP and user testing: SIPal is live, every AI answer is checked before it shows, and 3 users' feedback is built in

What SIPal is

An in-app guide for first-time SIP investors at two moments: a weekly check-in (how my funds did, why the market moved, is it normal) and a reminder 3 days before the debit (pay less this month, skip, move the date).

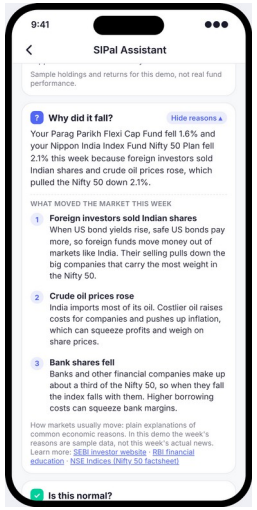
AI with a quality gate

AI only words the facts it is given. Each answer is checked (numbers, no advice, no fund tips, calm tone, a source), or a safe fallback shows. Golden set 18/20; advice-free 20/20; safety tests 17/17. **Where AI earns its place:** answering each investor's own question, in their own words.

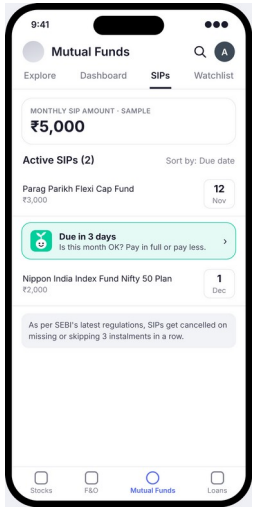
Try it live: SIPal MVP

nextleapgradprojectgrowwsipresearch.vercel.app/sipal

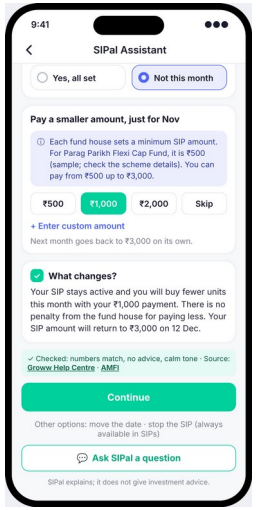
Sample data, no login. Not investment advice.



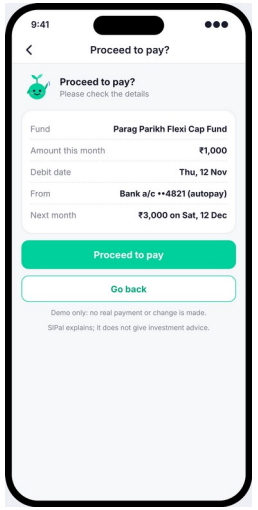
1 **Why it fell**



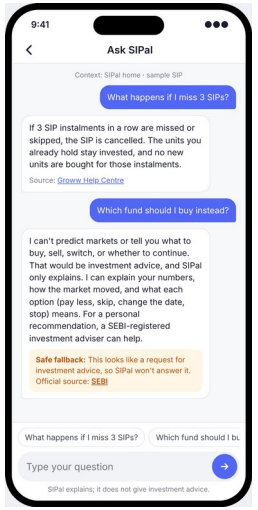
2 **SIPs tab**



3 **Pay less**



4 **Proceed to pay?**



5 **Advice declined**

User testing: what 3 first-time investors found, and what we changed

Tester	What they found	What we changed
User 1	Tabs didn't open; Popular Funds stuck loading; too many suggestions	Tabs work; fund cards shown; suggestions only in Ask SIPal
User 2	"Yes, all set" did nothing; no fund minimum or custom amount	"Proceed to pay?" screen; minimum-amount note; custom amount
User 3	The SIPal explanation took half the screen	Intro cut to one line; tasks as compact buttons
Own review	Had to zoom on phones; Enter hard in chat; Task 2 name clashed	Fits the phone screen; Enter sends; Task 2 renamed; lighter chat

Success and risks: SIPal aims for +2 to +4 points on 12-month active SIPs, and each risk has a clear mitigation

North star and target

Metric: % of first-time investors with an active SIP 12 months after starting

Target: +2 to +4 points for salaried 22-30 first-timers vs a control group (estimate)

Product metrics that move it

First-try debit success: successful debits / debits tried

Stop-to-adjust rate: skip, lower or new date / opened stop

Check-in reach: share opening the weekly check-in

Guardrails

No pressure: cancel stays one tap; time to cancel not worse

No nagging: one reminder per instalment; mute rate watched

AI gate: 95%+ grounded, 0 advice phrases

Risks and Mitigations



1 Read as investment advice

Risk: an answer sounds like a tip to buy, sell or stop.

Mitigation: advice requests get a fixed decline and a SEBI-adviser pointer; “not advice” on every screen.

2 Wrong or invented explanations

Risk: the AI gets a number or a market reason wrong.

Mitigation: AI only words given facts; every number is checked; a failed check shows standard text.

3 Pushy or too many alerts

Risk: nudges feel like pressure, or get muted and ignored.

Mitigation: weekly, not daily; one reminder per instalment; no urgency words; skip and cancel always visible.

4 Demo data, not real accounts

Risk: sample numbers differ from a real portfolio.

Mitigation: label all data as sample; launch only with Groww's portfolio data and a vetted market feed.

5 Small research samples

Risk: 4 interviews and 19 survey answers may not represent everyone.

Mitigation: A/B test against a control group; re-run the golden set after every change.

6 Privacy and free-tier limits

Risk: someone enters personal data, or the free AI quota runs out.

Mitigation: no login or PAN; nothing stored; rate limits, caching and a fixed fallback keep it working.